actors aligned with those militants with which it was at war. Further, although the ISI retained strong influence over many of Lashkar's senior leaders, these leaders did not always exercise control over the group's commanders or its rank-and-file. In other words, selectivity also failed to take account of internal group dynamics, since the state was supporting outfits whose own militants were sometimes involved in attacks against Pakistan.

The schizophrenia of this macro policy was amplified at the ground level by elements within the ISI who sometimes worked at cross-purposes. For example, David Headley's impression, according to his interrogators, was that the ISI felt tremendous pressure to stop the integration of Kashmir-centric outfits with those based in the Tribal Areas.[70] Yet one Pakistani researcher alleged that ISI operatives arranged meetings between previously Kashmir-centric groups and the Taliban in spring 2007 for the purpose of enhancing cooperation in Afghanistan to counter Indian influence.[71] According to that researcher, Abdul Rehman Makki, Lashkar's head of External Affairs responsible for liaising with other jihadi groups, attended.[72] It is possible Headley's interpretation was incorrect or that the ISI's calculus changed after the insurgency gained steam following the storming of the Lal Masjid in summer 2007. But it is equally plausible that one hand did not know what the other was doing or that different line officers were pursuing their own tactical objectives without due consideration of the wider strategic ramifications.

The questions of how much to contribute to the insurgency in Afghanistan and, to lesser degree, whether to fight against Pakistan drew different answers from various factions within Lashkar. Interviews with some of the group's leaders revealed fury at America's perceived occupation of Afghanistan and the belief that current policies in Pakistan had been imposed on the country by the US. This overlapped with anger about India's presence in Afghanistan and its perceived desire to destabilize Pakistan from across the Durand Line.[73] Entering the Afghan front presented an opportunity to fight the US *and* another avenue for harming India. Yet these leaders also made clear that liberating Kashmir remained the priority. According to several Lashkar members, the leadership continued to insist this was a more legitimate jihad, making some of the same arguments they had made since the 1990s: the number of security